

John L. Radford

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Summary

DevOps engineer and systems programmer with 6+ years at a production web hosting company. Applies computer science fundamentals and insightful technical leadership to build internal tooling, automation, and secure infrastructure end-to-end, from distributed KVM clusters to custom RAG pipelines, with an emphasis on coding clean user experience for internal teams. Writes production Perl and Python, mentors junior staff, owns Linux systems, and ships full-stack internal tools.

Technical Skills

Languages: Perl, Python, Bash, PHP, JavaScript

Infra & DevOps: Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu/FreeBSD), QEMU/KVM, Puppet, Ansible, Nginx, Apache, ELK Stack

Data & Caching: MySQL/MariaDB, Redis, ChromaDB

Security & Networking: SOC/SIEM, VPN, rate limiting, IP threat intelligence, HMAC auth, Workflow Automation

Tools: GitLab CI/CD, Netbox, CloudLinux, Icinga2, SureMDM, REST APIs, Plack/PSGI

Work Experience

DevOps Specialist & Systems Administrator - Pair Networks, Inc.

01/2023 – 05/2026

- Built a **Virtual Resource Manager** (Perl) spanning 2 network segments, 30-40 host systems, and thousands of guest VMs: per-host REST API agents broadcasting live CPU/mem/guest stats, a weighted-average rebalancing algorithm, and an interactive REPL CLI (`vrnctl`) for manipulating the QEMU/KVM clusters.
- Developed a **custom RAG pipeline** (Python): ingested docs from GitLab, wikis, and knowledge bases; chunked, vectorized, and stored in ChromaDB; deployed tailored internal LLMs to assist support staff.
- Built a **centralized IP threat intelligence system**: Perl modules querying 3 public threat intelligence APIs, persisted to a central store with Redis caching to eliminate redundant external calls.
- Developed a **Zendesk webhook API** (Perl Plack, HMAC-verified): auto-populated ticket fields from a username or account number, saving the support team an estimated 10-20 hours of manual lookup annually.
- Integrated **Nginx/Apache rate limiting** into the Puppet build system; built a quality assurance pipeline for false-positive monitoring and threshold tuning.
- Developed a **KPI metrics pipeline**: automated collection of core business metrics from billing and account systems into a central database, eliminating a recurring 1-2 hour manual reporting task each quarter.
- Integrated **CloudLinux** into the legacy build system and Puppet across a fleet of 20 shared servers; built LVE fault reporting tooling, custom control panel integrations, and an Ansible playbook for fleet-wide deployment.
- Developed a **centralized web statistics pipeline**: Perl modules parsing raw access logs into structured JSON aggregated across the entire fleet via Ansible.

NOC & Security Technician - Pair Networks, Inc.

01/2020 – 12/2023

- Promoted to concurrent Security and NOC roles: monitored, detected, and remediated intrusions; triaged live production server incidents (hardware and software).
- Simultaneously handled Level 2 support, abuse team, and internal account migrations.
- Helped maintain the internal ELK centralized logging stack and SOC/SIEM monitoring infrastructure.

Support Technician - Pair Networks, Inc.

08/2018 – 12/2020

- Resolved customer issues across web hosting, email, DNS, domains, databases, and PHP configurations.
- Automated **SSL renewal notifications**, eliminating a manual process and saving an estimated 200+ hours (roughly \$10-15K in labor costs) per year.
- Built deep Linux hosting expertise across the full web stack that underpins all subsequent engineering roles.

Open Source Projects

Web-LGSM - web portal for managing Linux game servers

Term::ReadLine::Repl - published CPAN REPL module; used in production `vrnctl` tooling

Acme::Shotgun - published CPAN module

Education

University of Pittsburgh - B.A., Humanities; Minor in Political Science (2017)